

# St. Lucia



St. Lucia is one of the most beautiful of the Caribbean Windward Islands. Ruled by France and the UK at different times in its past, the island retains the character of both.



## GEOGRAPHY

Volcanic and mountainous, with some broad fertile valleys. The Pitons, ancient lava cones, rise from the sea on the forested west coast.



## CLIMATE

Tropical, moderated by trade winds. May–October wet season brings daily warm showers. Rainfall is highest in the mountains.



## PEOPLE & SOCIETY

Population is a tension-free mixture of descendants of Africans, Caribs, and Europeans. Family life and the Roman Catholic Church are important to most St. Lucians. In rural areas, women often head the households and run much of the farming. Plantation and hotel owners are the richest group. There is growing local resistance to overdevelopment of the island for tourism.

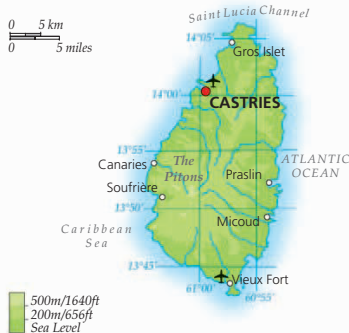


## THE ECONOMY

Bananas are still biggest export, but struggling to compete since loss of preferential access to EU market. Successful tourism. Offshore banking.



**INSIGHT:** *St. Lucia has two Nobel laureates, the most per capita in the world*



## FACTFILE

**OFFICIAL NAME:** Saint Lucia

**DATE OF FORMATION:** 1979

**CAPITAL:** Castries

**POPULATION:** 172,200

**TOTAL AREA:** 239 sq. miles  
(620 sq. km)

**DENSITY:** 730 people per sq. mile

**LANGUAGES:** English\*, French Creole

**RELIGIONS:** Roman Catholic 90%,  
other 10%

**ETHNIC MIX:** Black 83%, Mixed race 13%,  
Asian 3%, White 1%

**GOVERNMENT:** Parliamentary system

**CURRENCY:** East Caribbean dollar =  
100 cents